

### White Hart Public House

One of the earliest of Thurmaston's public houses, the White Hart was used as a Coroner's Court in 1822 for the inquest of William Lane, the soldier murdered by John Bishop Allen just a few yards away ([see p.48](#)).

Many licensed victuallers have served here during its lifetime, often combining the trade with another profession, as was frequently the custom during the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries. A grazier, carpenter, butcher, horse breaker and framework knitter have all come and gone. During the 1930s one landlord kept a large black pig called Larry Gains (after a famous heavy-weight boxer), and the 1950s brought memories from one Thurmaston resident of medicinal stout being purchased from the back door. The name changed to The Taverna during the late 1980s and seemed to mark a downward trend and a period of troubled times. Despite being reverted back to its former designation the business was not able to recover. The photograph, above left, dated 1981 reveals happier days.



*c.2005 the final years of the White Hart, now boarded up, it's future uncertain. Ref:1236*